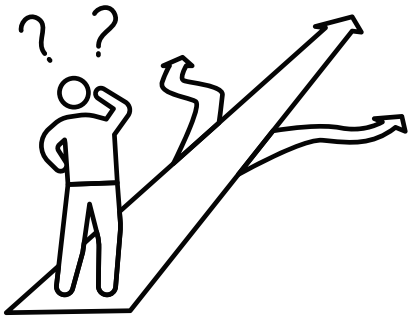
Empower



DECISION-MAKING
DISCERNING GOD'S WILL AND CALLING

SURRENDER TO DOING GOD's WILL - the key to any decision

Because God is God, He will have no trouble in communicating to us what He wants us to do. Our problem is doing God's will, not knowing God's will! We must be willing to do whatever He desires for us, before He will let us know His plan for us. This can be frightening, but if we really know God and His love, we will also trust Him that He will only give us good things.
John 7:17; Romans 12:1-2; Jeremiah 29:11; Matthew 7:9-11

5 MEANS TO DISCERNING GOD'S WILL

1. The Word of God - Psalm 119:105; Proverbs 6:22-23
Obviously, if something is contrary to a direct teaching in Scripture, it is not the will of God [i.e. marrying a non-Christian (2 Corinthians 6:14)]. But God can also speak to us concerning our specific situations from the bible. You will know in your heart that this is God's promise to you concerning your decision.

2. Personal Peace When We Pray - Philippians 4:6-7; Psalm143:8,10; Isaiah 30:21
Though you may not have all the answers yet, you will have a deep peace of heart, a rest in your heart, knowing that this is from God. The Holy Spirit will confirm in your heart that this is the way, even if it involves hardship or sadness.

3. Counsel From Mature Believers - Proverbs 15:22; 13:20; 19:20
Objective counsel from mature believers will be used to give perspective and direction. It is hard to get counsel from someone who does not have hidden motives. Finding the right counselors who know us, want our best and God's best is a challenge, but God will send them along. Your parents are some of the best counselors you will find. Notice that it is the abundance of counselors that gives wisdom. Most people will just tell you what you want to hear, especially your friends, because they don't want to jeopardize the friendship.

4. Wise Thinking - 1 Peter 1:13; Proverbs 3:5-6
God gave you a lot of leading when He gave you a brain. Use a plus/minus system to think through the good and bad points of any decision. The Scriptures teach us not to lean on our own understanding, but they don't say to not use our own understanding! Just don't depend on it only.

5. Providential Circumstances - Revelation 3:7-8; Acts 16:6-9
God will open doors to guide us. He will close doors to lead us to other open doors. He will provide opportunities.

**The more of the five things that we see agreeing, pointing in the same direction, the more certain we can be that this is God's will. If one or two agree, but the others don't, we have two possibilities. It may be God's will, but the wrong timing. Or, it may not be God's will. In either case, it's best to wait; time will clarify. Immaturity will press ahead when things are not clear and pay a big price! (Proverbs 19:2)

GOD IS SOVEREIGN

Remember, the foundation is surrendering to doing God's will. We can deceive ourselves. We can find verses to justify just about anything. We can "have peace" about a lot of things. Satan can open doors for us also. However, also remember this: God being God, He will not allow circumstances, governments, organizations, or anyone with authority over us to hinder His plan for us. In fact, He uses them to direct us to His plan for us (see Joseph in Genesis 50:20).

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